

ONE BILLION. ONE WINNER.

120

PHYSICAL CARDS

3-5

PLAYERS

~45

MINUTES: PLAYTEST TARGET

WHAT IS INSIDE

100 main-deck cards, 15 Startup cards and 5 Reference cards. Every playable card has a defined value and effect. All five startups begin at \$50M.

HOW TO PRINT

Pages 7–46 contain 20 paired front/back sheets, with six poker-size cards per sheet (2.5 × 3.5 inches). Print landscape at 100% / Actual Size. Use duplex with short-edge flipping. Test pages 7–8 before printing the full set.

HOW TO ASSEMBLE

Cut on the corner marks. Use opaque sleeves with a spare playing card behind each print for a consistent feel. Or print only the odd-numbered card pages and use opaque sleeves.

START PLAYING

Read pages 3–6. Shuffle only the 100-card main deck, deal 5 hidden cards each, then choose a Startup. No special attack or defense is guaranteed.

EVERY CARD. EVERY COPY.

CARD	VALUE	COPIES	CARD	VALUE	COPIES
U01 Neural AI	+\$50M	3	U21 Poach	+\$10M	4
U02 Flash Commerce	+\$50M	3	U22 Offer They Can't Refuse	+\$10M	1
U03 FinPay	+\$50M	3	U23 Patent Lawsuit	+\$10M	2
U04 RocketWorks	+\$50M	3	U24 Steal Customer	+\$10M	2
U05 Biotech	+\$50M	3	U25 Founder Scandal	+\$10M	2
U06 Chief Scientist	+\$125M	5	U26 PR Crisis	+\$10M	3
U07 Rockstar CTO	+\$100M	5	U27 Hostile Acquisition	+\$10M	1
U08 Elite Engineer	+\$75M	5	U28 Golden Handcuffs	+\$10M	4
U09 Growth Lead	+\$100M	4	U29 Best Lawyers in Town	+\$10M	2
U10 Rockstar CFO	+\$75M	3	U30 Raise Salary	+\$10M	2
U11 Fortune 500 Contract	+\$100M	3	U31 Not For Sale	+\$10M	2
U12 Enterprise Contract	+\$100M	4	U32 Crisis PR Team	+\$10M	3
U13 Government Contract	+\$125M	4	U33 Non-Compete	+\$10M	2
U14 Viral Launch	+\$125M	4	U34 Investor	+\$50M	3
U15 Viral Product	+\$125M	5	U35 Joint Venture	+\$10M	5
U16 Accelerator	+\$50M	2	U36 Ditch	+\$10M	7
U17 Strategic Partnership	+\$75M	3	U37 The Unicorn	REF	1
U18 Major Funding Round	+\$150M	3	U38 Your Turn	REF	2
U19 Government Grant	+\$50M	3	U39 Bank or Play	REF	1
U20 Investor Backchannel	+\$10M	2	U40 Partnerships	REF	1

DEAL FIVE. DRAW ONE. PLAY TWO.

SET UP IN FIVE MINUTES

Separate the 15 Startup cards and 5 Reference cards from the 100-card draw pile. Shuffle the draw pile and deal 5 hidden cards to every player. No particular attack or defense is guaranteed.

Deal each player 3 different Startup types from the Startup supply. They choose 1 and return the other 2; reshuffle before the next player chooses. Replace duplicate types within a deal. Different players may choose the same type.

YOUR COMPANY STARTS AT \$50M

Put your chosen Startup face-up. Its \$50M always counts and it can never be taken or discarded. All five startup types use the same rules. Choose a random first player and play clockwise.

THE FINISH LINE

Reach \$1,000M or more at the end of your own completed turn, after every effect and reaction has resolved. Only one player wins. Your partner does not share the win. Players are never eliminated.

1 / DRAW ONE

Draw 1 card from the draw pile. Whenever any effect takes your hand above 7, immediately choose and discard down to 7 before continuing. This applies after every draw or exchange, even outside your turn.

2 / PLAY UP TO TWO CARDS

For each card play, choose one card in your hand: bank it face-up in your startup for its printed valuation, or use its effect. You may play fewer than two, and you may choose the same kind of play twice. There is no payment to play a card.

Reaction cards may be used for their effects only at the printed trigger. On your turn you may bank a reaction instead. Cards such as Best Lawyers in Town and Crisis PR Team explicitly offer a normal card-play effect as well.

3 / COUNT YOUR VALUATION

Add your Startup, your banked cards and your shared Employees, then subtract active PR Crisis penalties. Count each card only once for your startup. Valuation never falls below \$0. Check the \$1B win, then pass.

ONE CARD. ONE CHOICE.

ONE CARD, ONE USE

Banking means placing the card upright in your startup. It adds its printed valuation, but its effect is unavailable. You cannot activate it later or take it back into your hand. Most attacks and defenses are worth only \$10M when banked.

Using an effect adds no bank valuation. Discard the card after resolving unless it says to stay. Keep ongoing effects sideways beside the affected startup, or attached beneath their Employee, to distinguish them from banked cards.

WHAT CAN POACH TAKE?

Take 1 positive-value card from another startup: an Employee, Growth or Funding asset, an Investor, or a banked tactic. A shared Employee is also eligible. Never take a Startup identity, a Reference or an active effect marker.

Move the card; its previous owner loses its valuation and its new owner gains it. A banked card stays banked after being taken. Its effect never reactivates.

REACTIONS ARE IMMEDIATE

Pause before an attack or Investor resolves. The target may use one matching reaction from hand, or their current partner may defend on their behalf. Reactions do not use either player's two card plays. The target and partner get one response total.

Non-Compete cancels its listed attack automatically and is discarded. It uses that response. Offer They Can't Refuse only overrides Golden Handcuffs against Poach. It cannot override any defense against Ditch. No further response follows Offer.

INVESTOR: A VISIBLE EXCHANGE

The target must have at least 1 card in hand. Give them the Investor face-up: it adds \$50M to their startup. Take 1 random card from their hand, with card backs facing you. They may shuffle their hand before you pick.

Not For Sale cancels the entire exchange: no valuation is added and no hand card transfers. Discard the Investor and defense. If you bank Investor in your own startup instead, it adds \$50M and no exchange happens.

FOUNDER SCANDAL: PRIVATE INFORMATION

The player using Founder Scandal privately sees every card in the target's hand. Return all cards unchanged and discard Scandal. No other player is entitled to see the hand. Crisis PR Team can cancel the reveal before it happens.

DEFENDING FOR A PARTNER

Partners may use an eligible defense for one another, but never have to. For Ditch, only the partner being ditched can play Golden Handcuffs. Nobody else can intervene. A banked defense never protects anything.

TOGETHER, UNTIL FURTHER NOTICE.

FORM A JOINT VENTURE

Use Joint Venture as one of your two card plays. Choose an unpartnered rival who agrees; you must also be unpartnered. Each of you must have 1 unshared Employee already in your startup. You cannot use Employees from your hand.

Each commits 1 Employee. Place the two cards beside Joint Venture, each nearest its contributor so ownership is clear. Remove them from the original startup rows. Both partners now count both Employees. The active Joint Venture card adds no valuation of its own.

THE TERMS STAY ON THE TABLE

Only one partner per player and exactly one committed Employee each. Partners keep separate hands, startups and turns. You cannot replace or withdraw a committed Employee at will. If an invitation is refused, keep the Joint Venture; no card play is spent.

You may attack a partner, but the venture ends only through Ditch or the removal of a committed Employee. Other attacks do not end it. After a venture ends, a new Joint Venture card can create a new partnership with any eligible, willing player.

IF SOMEONE TAKES A SHARED EMPLOYEE

Resolve any eligible defense first. If Poach or Hostile Acquisition succeeds, the attacker takes the chosen Employee. Return the other committed Employee to its original contributor and discard Joint Venture. The partnership ends; recalculate both startups.

DITCH SUCCEEDS

Play Ditch against your own partner. If unblocked, take both committed Employees into your startup and discard Joint Venture and Ditch. Your valuation stays the same because you already counted both cards. Your former partner loses both cards' shared valuation.

DITCH GETS BLOCKED

Your partner may react with Golden Handcuffs. They take both committed Employees instead. Their valuation stays the same; yours drops by the shared value. Discard Ditch, Golden Handcuffs and Joint Venture. The partnership ends. There is no counter to this reversal.

THE \$225M BETRAYAL

A Chief Scientist (\$125M) and Rockstar CTO (\$100M) are shared: each partner counts \$225M. You are at \$800M and your partner is at \$900M, including that shared value.

If you Ditch successfully: you stay at \$800M; they fall to \$675M. If they block Ditch: they stay at \$900M; you fall to \$575M. No bonus valuation is created when the employees move.

SETTLE THE TABLE DEBATE.

PATENT LAWSUIT: SKIP ONCE

A successful Lawsuit stays sideways beside the target as a reminder. At their next turn, discard it and skip that entire turn: no draw, card plays or win check. They may still react during other players' turns.

Only one pending Lawsuit per player; a second cannot target them while one is waiting. Best Lawyers in Town can cancel it immediately, or a partner can spend a card play to remove it before the skipped turn arrives.

PR CRISIS: A VISIBLE -\$75M

Keep PR Crisis sideways beside the affected startup. Subtract \$75M while it stays; its printed +\$10M bank value does not count. Each successful PR Crisis is a separate penalty and multiple copies stack.

Crisis PR Team can cancel an incoming PR Crisis or use one card play to discard an existing one from you or your partner. Removing it restores that \$75M. No manual score adjustment is needed.

ATTACHED DEFENSES

A Non-Compete used for protection sits under its Employee and adds no valuation. It automatically cancels the next Poach or Hostile Acquisition against that Employee, then is discarded. It does not block Ditch.

The attachment follows its Employee into a venture or to a new owner. If the Employee is discarded, discard its attachment too. If Non-Compete was banked for \$10M, it is just a positive-value card and protects nothing.

WHEN THE DRAW PILE RUNS OUT

Shuffle the main discard pile into a new draw pile. Never shuffle Startups or References into it. If both piles are empty, skip draws until cards are discarded. Effects that draw multiple cards take as many as available.

A card being resolved is discarded only after its effect finishes. It cannot draw itself during a reshuffle. If a hand effect takes you above 7, discard down immediately.

CLEAR TARGETS, SIMPLE OWNERSHIP

A card needs a legal target before it is played. You may not use an effect that cannot resolve; bank it instead if you want its valuation. Everyone may inspect face-up cards, hand sizes and the discard pile. Hidden card faces remain private unless an effect reveals them.

No free card gifts, swaps or binding verbal deals. Investor, Joint Venture and printed card effects handle transfers. Table talk, promises and bluffing are encouraged. A pending effect never awards a win before its reaction window finishes.

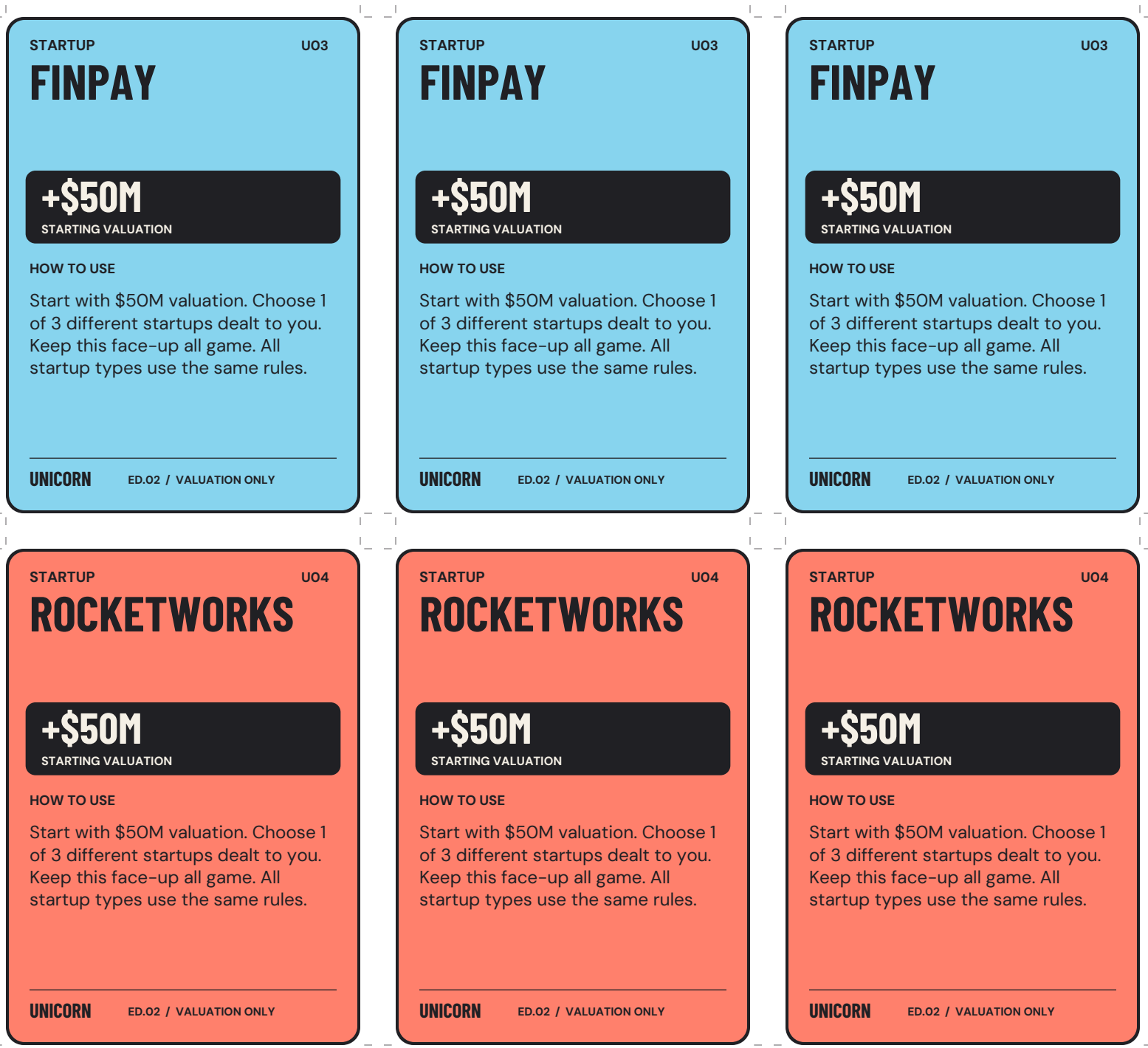
BUILT FOR A FIRST PLAYTEST

The draw pile contains 100 cards: 56 worth \$50M–\$150M and 44 tactics worth \$10M when banked. Five-card opening hands, one draw and up to two card plays aim for a game of about 45 minutes.

That is a design target, not a measured result. This valuation-only edition changes the pace and needs live testing with 3, 4 and 5 players. Use the same printed rules for the first session before adjusting the card quantities.













EMPLOYEE U06 CHIEF SCIENTIST +\$125M VALUATION IN YOUR STARTUP HOW TO USE Place face-up in your startup and add its valuation. You may commit this Employee to a Joint Venture. UNICORN ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY	EMPLOYEE U06 CHIEF SCIENTIST +\$125M VALUATION IN YOUR STARTUP HOW TO USE Place face-up in your startup and add its valuation. You may commit this Employee to a Joint Venture. UNICORN ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY	EMPLOYEE U07 ROCKSTAR CTO +\$100M VALUATION IN YOUR STARTUP HOW TO USE Place face-up in your startup and add its valuation. You may commit this Employee to a Joint Venture. UNICORN ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY
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EMPLOYEE U09

GROWTH LEAD

+\$100M

VALUATION IN YOUR STARTUP

HOW TO USE

Place face-up in your startup and add its valuation. You may commit this Employee to a Joint Venture.

UNICORN ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY

EMPLOYEE U09

GROWTH LEAD

+\$100M

VALUATION IN YOUR STARTUP

HOW TO USE

Place face-up in your startup and add its valuation. You may commit this Employee to a Joint Venture.

UNICORN ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY

EMPLOYEE U09

GROWTH LEAD

+\$100M

VALUATION IN YOUR STARTUP

HOW TO USE

Place face-up in your startup and add its valuation. You may commit this Employee to a Joint Venture.

UNICORN ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY

EMPLOYEE U09

GROWTH LEAD

+\$100M

VALUATION IN YOUR STARTUP

HOW TO USE

Place face-up in your startup and add its valuation. You may commit this Employee to a Joint Venture.

UNICORN ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY

EMPLOYEE U10

ROCKSTAR CFO

+\$75M

VALUATION IN YOUR STARTUP

HOW TO USE

Place face-up in your startup and add its valuation. You may commit this Employee to a Joint Venture.

UNICORN ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY

EMPLOYEE U10

ROCKSTAR CFO

+\$75M

VALUATION IN YOUR STARTUP

HOW TO USE

Place face-up in your startup and add its valuation. You may commit this Employee to a Joint Venture.

UNICORN ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY



EMPLOYEEU10

ROCKSTAR CFO

+\$75M

VALUATION IN YOUR STARTUP

HOW TO USE

Place face-up in your startup and add its valuation. You may commit this Employee to a Joint Venture.

UNICORNEd.02 / VALUATION ONLY

GROWTHU11

FORTUNE 500 CONTRACT

+\$100M

VALUATION IN YOUR STARTUP

HOW TO USE

Place face-up in your startup and add its valuation.

UNICORNEd.02 / VALUATION ONLY

GROWTHU11

FORTUNE 500 CONTRACT

+\$100M

VALUATION IN YOUR STARTUP

HOW TO USE

Place face-up in your startup and add its valuation.

UNICORNEd.02 / VALUATION ONLY

GROWTHU11

FORTUNE 500 CONTRACT

+\$100M

VALUATION IN YOUR STARTUP

HOW TO USE

Place face-up in your startup and add its valuation.

UNICORNEd.02 / VALUATION ONLY

GROWTHU12

ENTERPRISE CONTRACT

+\$100M

VALUATION IN YOUR STARTUP

HOW TO USE

Place face-up in your startup and add its valuation.

UNICORNEd.02 / VALUATION ONLY

GROWTHU12

ENTERPRISE CONTRACT

+\$100M

VALUATION IN YOUR STARTUP

HOW TO USE

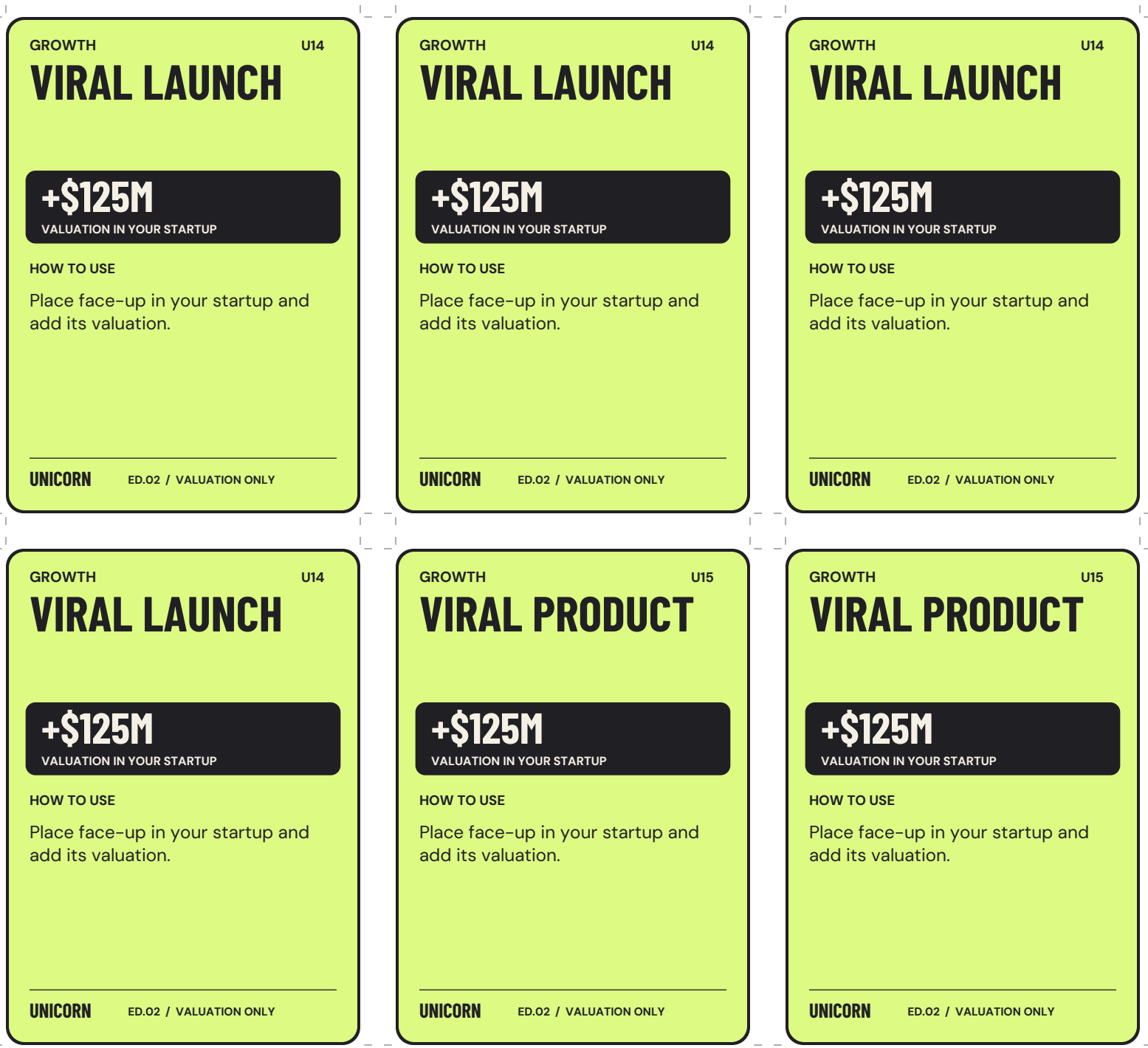
Place face-up in your startup and add its valuation.

UNICORNEd.02 / VALUATION ONLY

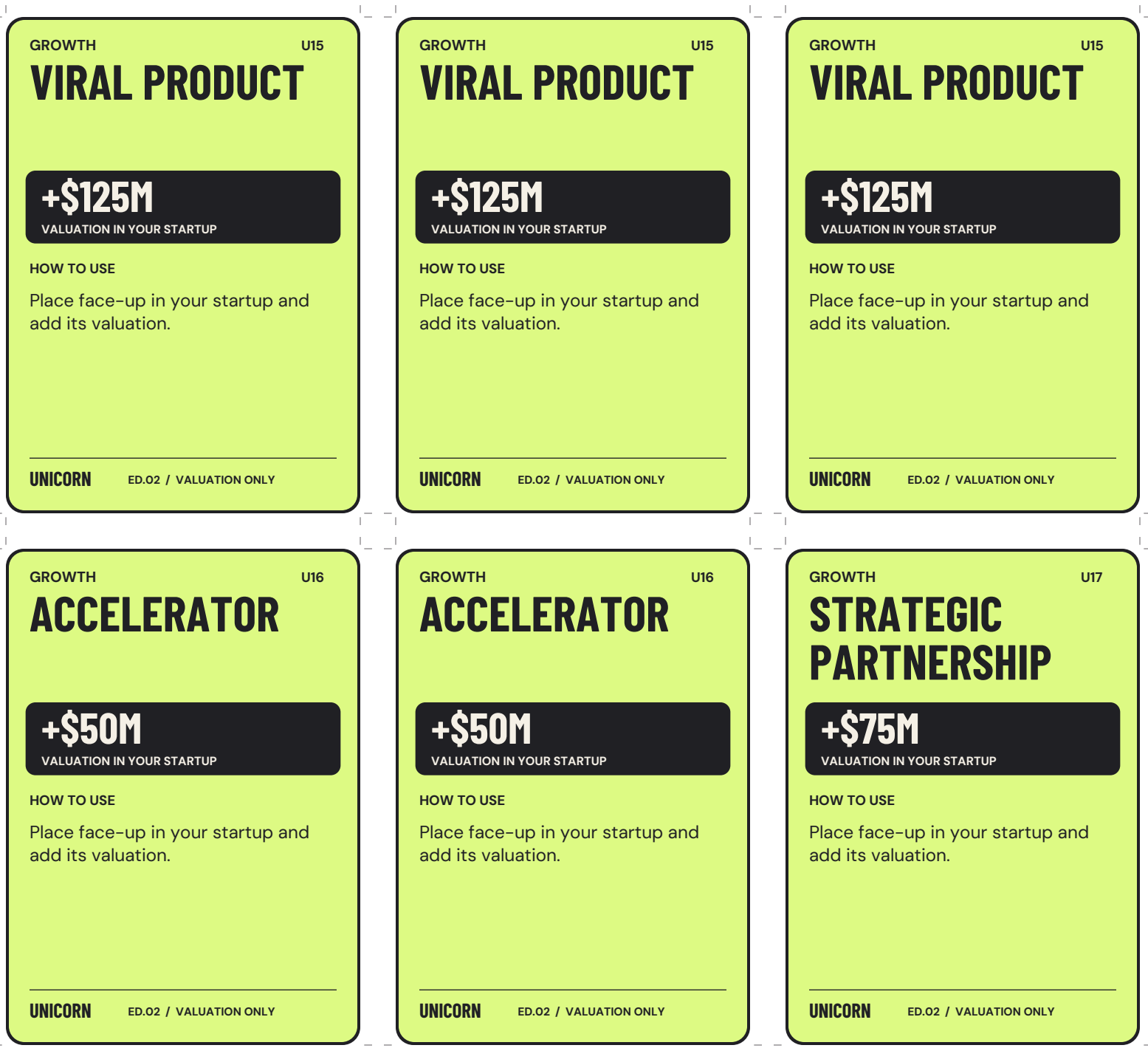


























ATTACK

U24

STEAL CUSTOMER

+\$10M

VALUATION IF BANKED

OR PLAY THIS EFFECT

Take 1 Contract from a rival's startup into yours. Discard this card.

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ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY

ATTACK

U25

FOUNDER SCANDAL

+\$10M

VALUATION IF BANKED

OR PLAY THIS EFFECT

Privately look at every card in 1 rival's hand. Return the hand unchanged. Only you see it. Discard this card.

UNICORN

ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY

ATTACK

U25

FOUNDER SCANDAL

+\$10M

VALUATION IF BANKED

OR PLAY THIS EFFECT

Privately look at every card in 1 rival's hand. Return the hand unchanged. Only you see it. Discard this card.

UNICORN

ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY

ATTACK

U26

PR CRISIS

+\$10M

VALUATION IF BANKED

OR PLAY THIS EFFECT

Place beside a rival's startup as a -\$75M valuation penalty. It stays until removed by Crisis PR Team. Its +\$10M bank value does not count here.

UNICORN

ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY

ATTACK

U26

PR CRISIS

+\$10M

VALUATION IF BANKED

OR PLAY THIS EFFECT

Place beside a rival's startup as a -\$75M valuation penalty. It stays until removed by Crisis PR Team. Its +\$10M bank value does not count here.

UNICORN

ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY

ATTACK

U26

PR CRISIS

+\$10M

VALUATION IF BANKED

OR PLAY THIS EFFECT

Place beside a rival's startup as a -\$75M valuation penalty. It stays until removed by Crisis PR Team. Its +\$10M bank value does not count here.

UNICORN

ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY



ATTACK
U27

HOSTILE ACQUISITION

+\$10M

VALUATION IF BANKED

OR PLAY THIS EFFECT

Take 1 Employee or Growth card from a rival into your startup. You may take a shared Employee. Discard this card.

UNICORN
ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY

DEFENSE
U28

GOLDEN HANDCUFFS

+\$10M

VALUATION IF BANKED

REACTION FROM YOUR HAND

React to Poach: cancel it. React to Ditch against you: take both shared Employees and end the venture. Discard this card.

UNICORN
ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY

DEFENSE
U28

GOLDEN HANDCUFFS

+\$10M

VALUATION IF BANKED

REACTION FROM YOUR HAND

React to Poach: cancel it. React to Ditch against you: take both shared Employees and end the venture. Discard this card.

UNICORN
ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY

DEFENSE
U28

GOLDEN HANDCUFFS

+\$10M

VALUATION IF BANKED

REACTION FROM YOUR HAND

React to Poach: cancel it. React to Ditch against you: take both shared Employees and end the venture. Discard this card.

UNICORN
ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY

DEFENSE
U28

GOLDEN HANDCUFFS

+\$10M

VALUATION IF BANKED

REACTION FROM YOUR HAND

React to Poach: cancel it. React to Ditch against you: take both shared Employees and end the venture. Discard this card.

UNICORN
ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY

DEFENSE
U29

BEST LAWYERS IN TOWN

+\$10M

VALUATION IF BANKED

OR PLAY THIS EFFECT

React: cancel Patent Lawsuit, Steal Customer or Hostile Acquisition. Or use 1 card play to remove 1 pending Lawsuit from you or your partner. Discard this.

UNICORN
ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY

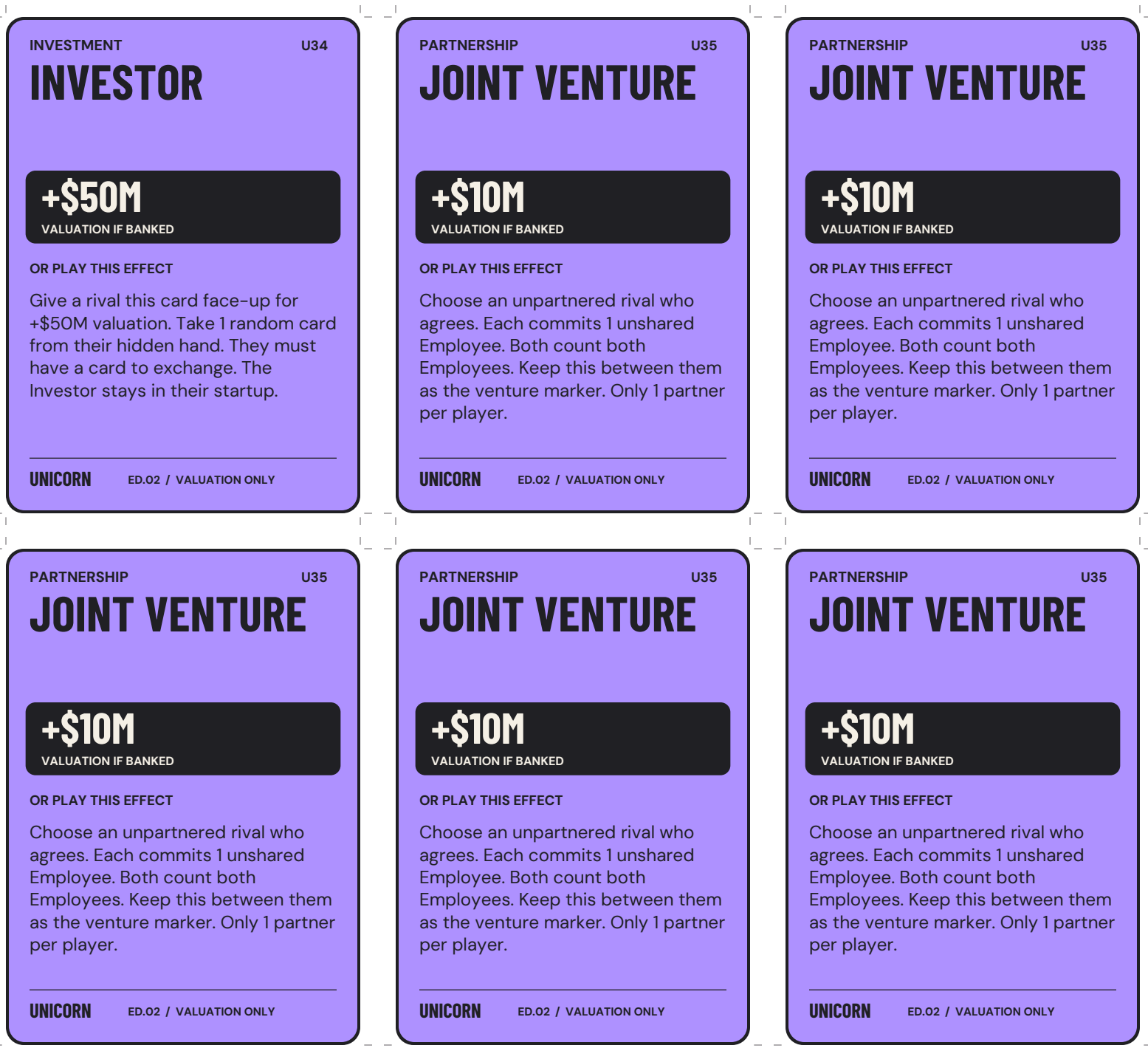


















ATTACK
U36

DITCH

+\$10M
VALUATION IF BANKED

OR PLAY THIS EFFECT

Take both Employees from your Joint Venture and end it. Your valuation stays the same; your partner loses their shared value. If they block Ditch, they take both instead. Discard this.

UNICORN
ED.02 / VALUATION ONLY

REFERENCE
U37

THE UNICORN

\$1B
THE FINISH LINE

HOW TO USE

At the end of your own completed turn, reach \$1,000M valuation after reactions to win. Only one player wins, even if partnered.

UNICORN
ED.02 / REFERENCE

REFERENCE
U38

YOUR TURN

QUICK RULES
KEEP BESIDE THE TABLE

HOW TO USE

Draw 1. Discard immediately if over 7. Play up to 2 cards: use an effect or bank its valuation. Recalculate. Reach \$1,000M at your turn's end to win.

UNICORN
ED.02 / REFERENCE

REFERENCE
U38

YOUR TURN

QUICK RULES
KEEP BESIDE THE TABLE

HOW TO USE

Draw 1. Discard immediately if over 7. Play up to 2 cards: use an effect or bank its valuation. Recalculate. Reach \$1,000M at your turn's end to win.

UNICORN
ED.02 / REFERENCE

REFERENCE
U39

BANK OR PLAY

QUICK RULES
KEEP BESIDE THE TABLE

HOW TO USE

Bank: place face-up for printed valuation. Its effect is unavailable. Play: use the effect; add no bank value. Reactions come from your hand and use no card plays.

UNICORN
ED.02 / REFERENCE

REFERENCE
U40

PARTNERSHIPS

QUICK RULES
KEEP BESIDE THE TABLE

HOW TO USE

Joint Venture: 1 Employee each; both count both. Ditch succeeds: attacker keeps both. Ditch blocked by Golden Handcuffs: defender keeps both. Either way, the venture ends.

UNICORN
ED.02 / REFERENCE

